

Growing up in Taipei, I was educated with both Eastern and Western values. At home, my parents shared their values with me such as respecting elders, putting the group first, and working hard because that's your responsibility. But through American movies, English classes, and my school's IEP program, I was also taught Western values like distinctiveness and creativity. The most important difference is that school taught me to speak up and stand up for what I believe is right.

For a long time, these felt like two opposing forces inside me. Should I follow tradition or forge my own path? Later on, I found out that having two different cultural values isn't my weakness, it's my advantage.

In group projects, I helped classmates who were too shy to share their ideas by genuinely encouraging them, showing humility and kindness. At the same time, I pushed our team to think creatively and engage more with the project. Some of my international friends came to me to understand Taiwanese culture. Meanwhile, some of my local friends shared videos with me and asked me to explain those Western jokes or social media trends to them.

I learned that true diversity isn't about choosing one culture over another. It's about having and respecting both at the same time, and showing others that different values can coexist. As I grow older, I want to keep being that person who has both cultural aspects and help people from all backgrounds understand each other and share different cultures and diversity.